

GIMP for Beginners, Part 3

Toolbox Demystified

The third article in our series on the GIMP will guide you through Toolbox, and help you to work with the various tools featured in it.



The **Toolbox** that appears on the left of the main window is the foundation of the GIMP. Initially, it may appear mind-boggling, especially for a person who has no background or experience with any graphics editing program. While a detailed description of the **Toolbox** is out of the scope of this article, it would be helpful to get acquainted with each tool that comes with it.

Note that this tutorial will begin with a modified version of the **Toolbox** since we had learnt about customising the GIMP interface in the first article under this series. You can get to know more about that in LFY's July 09 issue.

Before we get started, we will cover 'selections'. Here, rather than discussing any type of selection tool, we will learn

about the nature of selection.

A 'selection' can be done by using different tools; you can use 'figure selection', 'colour selection' or even 'path selection'. Every 'selection' shows two types of traits, i.e., passive and active.

Passive selection: A 'passive selection' transpires at the time of drawing or editing a selection, and does not allow any drawing or painting while working with it. The passive selection will either vanish or change into active mode if you attempt to draw anything inside it.

Active selection: An 'active selection' is just a normal selection in which you can draw or paint. To distinguish between the two, the GIMP drafts the active selection with continuous blinking/moving dots. Refer to Figure 1 for more accurate details.